

TRAINING WEEK COMPLETE PLAN

Everything in one place, inside the day it belongs to: lifts, activation, stretching, abs, hip extension, ankle-knee-hip work and fascia. Nothing lives in a separate section — open your day and work top to bottom.

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY	MAIN LIFTS	JOINT FOCUS	HIP EXTENSION	ABS	FASCIA
MON	Legs	Ankle + hip mobility (prep)	Heavy horizontal	Anti-extension	Slow melting stretch
TUE	Chest + triceps	Ankle	Abduction (light)	Anti-rotation	Release + proprioception
WED	Back (V-taper)	Knee	—	Obliques + carries	Elastic: vertical
THU	Shoulders	Hip	Unilateral / steps	Lower abs	Long-chain stretch
FRI	Arms	Integration + balance	Hinge (gated)	Flexion (gated)	Elastic: lateral

READING THE TAGS

Every line is tagged so you can see what it is for and what is safe to drop.

- HIP EXT** Glute and hip-extension work
- JOINTS** Ankle, knee or hip resilience work
- FASCIA** Elastic, long-chain or release work
- OPTIONAL** Drop first when time is short
- PHYSIO** Clear with your physio before loading. Substitutions are on the day.

TWO RULES THAT SHAPE EVERYTHING

- Before you lift: movement only.** Long static holds before heavy sets temporarily reduce strength.
- After you lift: this is where the 30-second holds go.**

ONE JOINT PER DAY

Ankle, knee and hip each have a full rotation of work. Doing all three every day is roughly 35 extra minutes, which is not sustainable on top of these sessions. One joint per day covers every gap at about 12 minutes.

BE HONEST ABOUT THE CLOCK

Full sessions land at **80–95 minutes**. If that does not fit your week, cut the **OPTIONAL** lines first, then the fascia block — not the main lifts and not the joint work. A 60-minute session you actually do beats a 90-minute one you skip.

STOP RULE

Nothing here should send pain down your leg. If a movement or a stretch does, that is nerve tension, not muscle tightness — stop that item and flag it. Hamstring stretches, deep hip flexion and the banded hip-flexor march are the usual culprits. Anything your physio has prescribed replaces the equivalent item here.

01 MONDAY

Legs · heavy hip extension · abs (anti-extension)

80-95 MIN

1 PREP — dynamic, 8 min

Easy cardio — bike or incline walk	5 min
Cat-cow · hip circles · band pull-aparts	8 / 8ea / 2×15
Knee-to-wall ankle rock JOINTS — opens the ankle before the leg press	2 × 10ea
90/90 hip rotation switches JOINTS	2 × 8ea
Single-leg balance JOINTS	2 × 20s ea
Glute bridge HIP EXT — so the glutes drive the press, not your low back	1 × 15
Leg swings · bodyweight squats	10ea / 10

2 MAIN LIFTS — heavy hip extension is folded in here

Leg press PHYSIO	3 × 10–15
Full foot on the platform. Stop before your lower back lifts off the pad.	
Hip thrust, dumbbell or barbell HIP EXT — heels, ribs down, squeeze at the top	4 × 8–12
Leg extension	3 × 12–15
Seated leg curl	3 × 12–15
Dumbbell Bulgarian split squat — shorten the range if the hip pinches	3 × 8–10ea
Cable kickback HIP EXT	3 × 12–15ea
Single-leg calf raise JOINTS — unilateral fixes the side-to-side gap a machine hides	3 × 12ea
Frog pump finisher HIP EXT OPTIONAL	2 × 20

Heavy-glute swap-ins if a machine is taken or you want variety: glute drive machine 3 × 10–12, or single-leg hip thrust 3 × 10 each.

3 ABS — anti-extension (front core)

Dumbbell dead bug — light DB at arm's length, ribs pinned down	3 × 10ea
Plank with dumbbell drag-through	3 × 8ea
Overhead dumbbell march	3 × 30s

4 COOL-DOWN — 2 min easy walk, then hold and breathe

Standing quad stretch	30s ea
Calf stretch against wall · soleus with knee bent	45s ea
Kneeling hip flexor stretch FASCIA — long hold; this is the slow melting work	2 min ea
Wide-stance adductor stretch FASCIA	2 min
Single knee-to-chest — gentle; back off if anything travels down the leg	30s ea

Short on time — cut in this order: frog pump → Bulgarian split squat → cable kickback. Leg press, hip thrust and leg curl are the ones that matter.

1

PREP

— dynamic, 7 min

Easy cardio	5 min
Cat-cow · hip circles · band pull-aparts	8 / 8ea / 2×15
Band external rotation — shoulder prep before pressing	2 × 12ea
Wall slides · arm swings · push-ups as a ramp-up	10 / 10 / 8–10

2

MAIN LIFTS

Incline dumbbell press — upper chest; control down, press up and slightly together	4 × 8–12
Flat machine or dumbbell press	3 × 8–12
Incline cable fly or pec deck — the stretch that builds the chest line	3 × 12–15
Chest dips — lean forward; stop when reps stop being clean	2–3 sets
Overhead triceps extension — long head; elbows forward, ribs down	3 × 10–12
Rope pushdown	3 × 12–15

3

ANKLE

JOINTS

— 12 min; the thinnest-covered joint in the plan

Knee-to-wall dorsiflexion — range first; a stiff ankle sends load up to the knee	3 × 10ea
Eccentric heel drop off a step, 3s lower — the Achilles builder	3 × 10ea
Tibialis raise, back to a wall, toes up — the front of the shin, trained by nothing else here	3 × 15–20
Banded eversion and inversion — peroneals; this is your rolled-ankle insurance	2 × 15ea way
Single-leg balance, eyes closed	3 × 30s ea

4

HIP EXTENSION

HIP EXT

— light abduction, 5 min

Seated hip abduction machine — upper glute; slow out, slower back	3 × 15–20
Banded glute bridge with abduction at the top	OPTIONAL 3 × 15

5

ABS

— anti-rotation

Cable Pallof press — resist the twist; ribs and hips stay square	3 × 12ea
Half-kneeling cable chop — light and controlled, no yanking	3 × 12ea
Suitcase carry — one heavy DB; stay perfectly upright	3 × 30–40m

6

COOL-DOWN

— holds and release

Doorway pec · overhead triceps · kneeling lat on a bench	30s ea
Lacrosse ball under the foot	FASCIA — the foot anchors the whole back line 60s ea
Slow foam roll: lats, quads, calves	FASCIA — never the lower back 30–60s ea

Short on time — cut in this order: banded glute bridge → chest dips → the chop. Keep the full ankle block — it is the gap this day exists to close.

1

PREP

— dynamic, 7 min

Easy cardio	5 min
Cat-cow · hip circles · band pull-aparts	8 / 8ea / 2×15
Scap shrugs from a dead hang — teaches the shoulder blade to move first	1 × 10
Band straight-arm pulldown · face pulls — lights up the lats before you pull heavy	2×15 / 2×15

2

MAIN LIFTS

— width first, then thickness

Lat pulldown, wide or neutral grip — elbows down toward your pockets; hands are hooks	4 × 8–12
Chest-supported row — chest stays on the pad; pull to your lower ribs	4 × 10–12
Straight-arm pulldown — pure lat isolation, the V-flare movement	3 × 12–15
One-arm dumbbell or cable row — braced; elbow to the back pocket, no torso twist	3 × 10–12ea
Face pull or reverse pec deck — rear delts; what caps the shoulder from behind	3 × 15–20

3

KNEE

JOINTS — 12 min; tendon loading, which the main plan has none of

Spanish squat isometric, heavy band behind the knees	3 × 30–45s
The best patellar tendon loader. Wall sit for the same time if you have no band.	
Slow step-down from a low box, 3s lower — eccentric control, where knees usually fail	3 × 8ea
Banded terminal knee extension	3 × 15ea
Lateral step-down — frontal plane; the direction football punishes	2 × 8ea
Reverse Nordic curl, shallow range	OPTIONAL 2 × 6

4

ABS

— obliques and lateral core

Side plank with a dumbbell on the top hip	3 × 20–40s ea
Cable lateral hold — stand side-on and simply resist the pull	3 × 20–30s ea
Farmer's carry, two dumbbells	OPTIONAL 3 × 40m

5

ELASTIC + COOL-DOWN

FASCIA — 10 min; legs are fresh today, so the hops go here

Rope skipping	PHYSIO 5 × 30s
Ankle pogo hops, minimal knee bend	PHYSIO 3 × 20
Med-ball chest pass into a wall — upper-body elastic work, zero impact	3 × 10
Lat stretch holding an upright, hips sitting back · doorway pec	30s ea
Thoracic extension over a foam roller — upper back only, never the lower back	30–45s

Short on time — cut in this order: farmer's carry → reverse Nordic → med-ball pass. Never cut the pulldown, chest-supported row or straight-arm pulldown — they are the V-taper.

1

PREP

— dynamic, 7 min

Easy cardio	5 min
Cat-cow · hip circles · band pull-aparts	8 / 8ea / 2×15
Band external rotation · wall slides	2×15ea / 10
Empty-hand lateral raises · arm circles — grooves the pattern before you load it	2×15 / 10ea way

2

MAIN LIFTS

— side delts are the width, not the press

Seated dumbbell or machine press — back supported, shoulder blades on the pad	4 × 8–12
Dumbbell lateral raise — lift with the elbow, stop at shoulder height, no shrugging	4 × 12–20
Cable lateral raise — constant tension; light enough that the shoulder does the work	3 × 15
Rear delt fly or reverse pec deck	3 × 15–20
Shrugs OPTIONAL	3 × 12–15

3

HIP

JOINTS

 — 12 min; rotation, adductors and hip-flexor strength

90/90 hip rotation switches — rotation is the range this plan otherwise never trains	3 × 8ea
Copenhagen plank, knee on a bench	3 × 15–20s ea
Adductors — the biggest gap, and groin strains are one of football's most common injuries.	
Banded hip flexor march PHYSIO	3 × 12ea
The psoas attaches to your lumbar spine — drop it the moment anything travels down the leg.	
Side-lying clam or hip abduction	3 × 15ea

4

HIP EXTENSION

HIP EXT

 — unilateral and step patterns, 6 min

Dumbbell step-up, knee-height box — lower the box if deep hip flexion bothers the leg	3 × 10ea
Dumbbell reverse lunge	3 × 10ea
Single-leg glute bridge OPTIONAL	3 × 12ea

5

ABS

— lower abs

Captain's-chair knee raise PHYSIO — curl hips toward ribs; no leg swinging	3 × 10–15
Reverse crunch on a bench	3 × 12–15
Lying leg raise, dumbbell between the feet PHYSIO	3 × 10–12

6

COOL-DOWN

— holds and long-chain work

Cross-body rear delt · doorway pec · overhead triceps · upper trap	30s ea
Lunge with overhead reach FASCIA — long-chain, keep moving through it	2 × 8ea
Standing side bend, arm overhead FASCIA	2 × 8ea
Kneeling hip flexor stretch	60–90s ea

Short on time — cut in this order: shrugs → single-leg glute bridge → reverse lunge. Both lateral raises stay — they are the highest-value movement for shoulder width.

1PREP

— dynamic, 7 min

Easy cardio	5 min
Cat-cow · hip circles · band pull-aparts	8 / 8ea / 2×15
Wrist circles · flexor and extensor rocks	10 ea
Band curls · band pushdowns — blood into the elbows before loading them	2×15 / 2×15

2MAIN LIFTS

Close-grip press or dips — keep this moderate; you pressed yesterday	3 × 8–12
Overhead triceps extension	3 × 10–12
Rope pushdown	3 × 12–15
Incline dumbbell curl — deeper stretch; upper arms still, no swinging	3 × 10–15
Hammer curl OPTIONAL	3 × 10–12

3HIP EXTENSION

HIP EXT

 — hinge; the second hard glute day

Dumbbell Romanian deadlift PHYSIO	3 × 8–12
Hips back, dumbbells close to the legs, feel the hamstrings stretch.	
45° back extension, glute-biased PHYSIO — push the hips into the pad, squeeze at the top	3 × 12–15
Cable pull-through PHYSIO OPTIONAL	3 × 12–15
Lying leg curl	3 × 12–15

UNTIL HINGING IS CLEARED

Swap the three gated lines for: hip thrust 3 × 10–12 and cable kickback 3 × 12–15 each. You lose very little — thrusts are a top-tier glute builder and they do not load the spine in flexion.

4INTEGRATION

JOINTS

 — 8 min; ties ankle, knee and hip together

Single-leg Romanian deadlift, bodyweight PHYSIO — balance and hinge in one	2 × 8ea
Lateral step-down	2 × 8ea
Balance on a cushion, eyes closed	3 × 30s ea

5ABS

— flexion; the one loaded-flexion day of the week

Cable crunch PHYSIO — ribs toward hips; arms hold the rope, abs move the weight	3 × 12–15
Ab crunch machine PHYSIO OPTIONAL	3 × 12–15
Hollow hold or plank to finish	3 × 30–45s

6ELASTIC + COOL-DOWN

FASCIA

 — 10 min, lateral direction

Skater hops, side to side PHYSIO	4 × 20s
Lateral line hops, small and quick PHYSIO	3 × 20
Overhead triceps · biceps stretch, palm flat on a wall behind you	30s ea
Wrist flexor stretch	30s ea
Foam roll lats, quads, calves — skip the lower back	30–60s ea

Short on time — cut in this order: hammer curl → ab crunch machine → cable pull-through.

MAKE IT KEEP WORKING

PROGRESSION

Start at the bottom of each rep range. Add reps week to week. When **every set** hits the top of the range with clean form, add the smallest weight jump available and drop back to the bottom. Repeat.

Example, an 8–12 lift:

Wk 1 10, 9, 8

Wk 2 11, 10, 9

Wk 3 12, 12, 12

Wk 4 +weight → back to 8–10

JOINT AND FASCIA WORK IS DIFFERENT

Don't chase load on the **JOINTS** and **FASCIA** lines. Progress those by adding a rep, a few seconds, or better control — tendon and collagen remodel over 6–24 months, not weeks. Consistency beats intensity here.

KEEP THE EXERCISES

Run the same movements for 12–13 weeks. Change one only if it hurts or the equipment is taken. You improve by getting better at a movement, not by collecting new ones.

DELOAD

If performance drops across several sessions and fatigue stays high — or roughly every 6–7 weeks — take one week at half the sets or noticeably lighter loads. It is part of the program, not a failure.

IF THE WEEK IS TOO BIG

Cut in this order, across every day:

- Every **OPTIONAL** line — saves about 10 min a session
- The **FASCIA** block, except the skipping
- One accessory from the main lift block

Never cut: the first two main lifts, the joint block for that day, or the cool-down stretches on Monday.

TRACK FOUR THINGS

- Seven-day average body weight — never a single day
- Waist measurement, once a week
- Front, side and back photos every 4 weeks — same lighting, time of day, distance
- Strength on: pulldown, chest-supported row, incline press, leg press, hip thrust

NON-NEGOTIABLES

- **Sleep 7–8 h.** Recovery is where definition is built, and it is what protects your back.
- **Rest days are training.** Never double up two sessions to catch up — push the missed day forward.
- **Don't stack hard cardio next to Monday.** 7,000–10,000 steps a day covers the rest.
- **Waist stays lean.** Skip heavy loaded side bends — they can thicken the waist and work against the V-taper.

THE GATE, ONCE MORE

Every **PHYSIO** item is worth having and worth waiting for. Adding them before you are cleared risks the one thing that would actually derail 13 weeks — a flare-up that costs three weeks of consistency.

General training information, not individual medical advice. Your physio's phased return plan overrides anything in this document.